

Figure 2: OpenNMS reporting

- Full featured and infinitely flexible.
- Its *Path outages* feature minimises excessive alerting.
- Reasonable support costs through the OpenNMS Group.

Cons

- Steep learning curve.
- Interface not very intuitive.
- Most customisation requires learning and modifying various config files.
- Money saved on licensing may have to be spent on development and maintenance.

Paessler

After re-designing its Web interface completely, Paessler has added support for an HTML interface for a host of mobile device platforms. Its interface has integrated Google Maps, which allows this software to display geographical maps for creating custom network views.

The pros and cons of Paessler are listed below.

Pros

- Low price.
- Flexible monitoring for apps, networks and more.
- Includes many useful features at no extra cost, e.g., Netflow, high-availability, remote probes.
- Flexible alerting, comprehensive reporting.

Cons

- Map designer falls short.
- Dashboards are not easily customised.
- Manually configuring sensors is not recommended.

SolarWinds

SolarWinds products are used by millions of users across the globe for the maintenance of network devices. Offering an excellent UI design and mobile accessibility, SolarWinds boasts of features like customisable as well as automated network mapping.

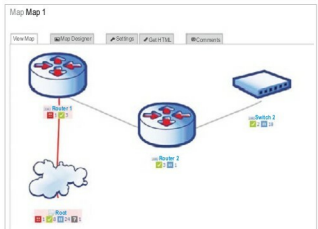


Figure 3: Paessler's map designer

SolarWinds has the following pros and cons.

Pros

- Excellent UI design.
- Customisable, automated network mapping.
- Great community support from Thwack.
- Mobile access.
- Native VMware support.

Cons

- Can't configure alerts from the Web console.
- *Group Dependency* configuration is clumsy.
- Reporting module needs better ad-hoc reports.
- No native support for Microsoft Hyper-V, but only for SNMP. 

References

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